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Sudan, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Central African Republic

Section Title(S)

9 SANZA , A CHARACTERISTIC FEATURE OF ZANDE LANGUAGE AND THOUGHT 1956

(7) Other occasions of use of *sanza* are in connexion with food and drink, especially beer. A man wants to invite a couple of friends from a company of men sitting in his home to drink beer with him but he does not wish to invite the rest of the company. He gets up as though to go away from them, and as he walks away he calls out to these two men 'now get up, please. That journey (business) of ours which we talked about yesterday, I am anxious to get it done'. The others think that he and his two friends have something to do and will be moving out of the homestead or be conducting private business in it, so they take the hint and leave. When they have left, the owner of the homestead and his two friends start their beer-drinking.

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(8) A man hears that his blood-brother's beer is ready for drinking and comes to his home for a drink. He enters the homestead and says to members of the family 'oh, children, you draw water for me, sir, I am dying of thirst'. The owner of the homestead can hardly refuse to take this hint, especially as the visitor is his blood-brother, but he is determined to give him as little of the beer as possible. He says 'my blood-brother, the wife has made a little maize-beer (it is really millet-beer), just a wee drop, for it mostly got spoilt in the straining. However, I am not a bad blood-brother and you shall have a sip of it since you are thirsty'. The visitor started with a *sanza* by asking for water and his blood-brother excuses himself for not offering him more than a gourdful of beer by two other *asanza*, that the beer is not of the best quality and that it got spoilt in the straining. The visitor drinks the beer offered to him and, being pleased, says 'oh, sir, when I tell people what a good fellow you are, it is this sort of thing I am thinking of'; and he continues in the language of the joking relationship—what Azande  215 call *buga*—between blood-brothers: 'my witchcraft is so active inside me that I might have killed you (I was so longing for a drink of beer); now the rubbing-board oracle would not accuse me (of witchcraft)'. He says that he would not harm his blood-brother because he is so grateful for the drink. The reference to witchcraft is a joking *sanza*. He does not confess to being a witch, though Azande would say that one cannot

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tell when a man makes this sort of remark in fun whether his pretence to be a witch may not be a double pretence, a subtle indication that he really is one.

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